

SARA LICCIARDI

Department of Economics and Statistics

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Last Update: September 2026

RESEARCH FIELD

Macroeconomics; Monetary economics; Fiscal policy; Public economics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics

Naples School of Economics

◇ Supervisors: Prof. Antonio Acconcia, Dr. Riccardo Silvestrini

Naples, Italy

2024 – Ongoing

Ph.D. Visiting Period

London Business School

◇ Supervisor: Prof. Paolo Surico

London, United Kingdom

Sept 2026 – Ongoing

M.S. in Economics and Finance

“La Sapienza” University of Rome

◇ Cumulative GPA: 4.00, *Highest distinction*

◇ Thesis: *The policy–mix impact on inequality: A micro–based analysis*

◇ Supervisor: Prof. Valeria Patella; Co–advisor: Prof. Massimiliano Tancioni

Rome, Italy

2022 – 2024

Exchange Program

Université Libre de Bruxelles

Bruxelles, Belgium

Jan – Jun 2024

B.S. in Business Economics

Department of Economics, University of Salento

◇ Cumulative GPA: 3.93, *Highest distinction*

◇ Thesis: *Investing in education. Economic Theory and RRP Compared*

◇ Supervisor: Prof. Felice Russo

Lecce, Italy

2019 – 2022

ADVANCED EDUCATION

Numerical Methods for Fiscal and Monetary Policy Analysis Barcelona School of Economics. Lecturer: Prof. Davide Debortoli	Barcelona, Spain Jul 2025
Naples Summer School of Economics and Finance Naples School of Economics ◊ Behavioral Macroeconomics – Prof. Nicola Pavoni ◊ Historical Economics – Prof. Francesco Drago	Naples, Italy Jun 2025
Knowledge Graphs for Economics and Finance Bank of Italy. Lecturer: Prof. Eleonora Laurenza	Naples, Italy Jun 2025
Financial Time Series and High Frequency Econometrics Italian Econometrics Society & University of Salerno ◊ Lecturers: Profs. Vincenzo Candila, Alessandra Amendola, Giovanni Bonaccolto	Bertinoro, Italy Jun 2024
Difference-In-Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data CEPR & EABCN	Online May 2024

WORK IN PROGRESS

Wage and Tax Bracket Erosion: Where Inflation Losses Fall

Abstract: This paper studies how inflation affects after-tax earnings through two channels: real wage erosion and bracket creep. A tractable model shows that the distributional incidence of inflation depends on workers' positions relative to tax kinks and on the relative strength of nominal wage and tax-bracket rigidities. The progressive tax schedule is a key mechanism transmitting inflation from gross to net earnings inequality, as it determines workers' exposure to wage erosion, bracket creep, or both. The incidence of inflation is therefore neither inherently progressive nor regressive; instead, it is shaped by the interaction between wage-setting and fiscal institutions, together with the distribution of earnings around tax thresholds. I summarize these distributional effects using two novel inequality measures that capture, respectively, the average level and dispersion of inflation-induced losses. I quantify the mechanism using the Italian institutional setting, which closely approximates a benchmark with fully rigid tax brackets. Counterfactual exercises show that partial bracket indexation of about 40 percent is sufficient to equalize inflation-induced losses across tax brackets. Full indexation, by contrast, produces larger but non-monotonic gains in after-tax income and entails a substantially greater loss of fiscal revenue.

Keywords: real bracket creep, nominal wage indexation, fiscal frag, tax policy, distributional effects of inflation.

JEL Codes: E31, E60, J31, D31, H20.

Presented at: 7th Naples Summer School of Economics and Finance, Poster session; 6th Sailing the Macro Workshop 2026, Poster session; Ph.D. NSE internal seminar; 5th Ph.D. and Post-Docs NSE Workshop; Bank of Italy Conference - 37th SUERF Colloquium, Poster Session*

Time-Varying Policy with Andrea Ferrara and Francesco Simone Lucidi

TEACHING & WORKING EXPERIENCE

Economics Tutor, “La Sapienza” University of Rome	Rome, Italy
Microeconomics and macroeconomics teaching (undergraduate)	2024
Junior Economist, City Hall	Lecce, Italy
Intern at the Economic and Financial Service	2022

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Ph.D. Representative	Naples, Italy
Ph.D. Quality Management Unit, NSE	2025 – Ongoing

WORKSHOPS, CONFERENCES

◇ Member of the Organizing Support Team – 6 th Sailing the Macro Workshop	2026
◇ Organizer, Peer Reviewer – 5 th NSE Ph.D. and Post-Doctoral Workshop	2026
◇ Peer Reviewer, Session Chair – 4 th NSE Ph.D. and Post-Doctoral Workshop	2025

AWARDS & GRANTS

Ph.D. Scholarship	
Naples School of Economics	2024 – Ongoing
Best Master Student and Thesis Innovation Award	
Fondazione Roma Sapienza	Nov 2024
Summer School SiDE Scholarship	
Bank of Italy	Jun 2024
Exchange Program Grant	
“La Sapienza” University of Rome	Jan 2024
M.S. Scholarship & Premio Laurea	
DiSCO Lazio	2022 – 2024

B.S. Scholarship
ADISU Puglia

2019 – 2022

OTHER ACTIVITIES

Voluntary for Education, Save the Children
Math teaching for secondary school students

Lecce, Italy
2022

LANGUAGES Italian: Mother tongue
 English: Proficient
 Spanish: Intermediate
 French: Intermediate

SKILLS Programming: Python, MATLAB, Dynare, Stata
 $\text{\LaTeX}$: Overleaf
 Microsoft Office Suite: Word, Excel, PowerPoint

REFERENCES

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